Tribhuvan University

Faculty of Humanities and Social Science

LOST AND FOUND WEB APP

A PROJECT PROPOSAL

Submitted to

Department of Computer Application

Hetauda School Of Management and Social Science

In partial fulfillment of the requirements for the Bachelors in Computer Application

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Introduction to Proposed Project

In daily life, losing personal belongings is a very common problem. Especially in colleges, schools, offices, and public places, people often misplace important things such as identity cards, notebooks, mobile phones, wallets, or accessories. Once these items are lost, the chances of recovering them become very low because there is no proper system that connects the person who lost the item with the one who found it.

Currently, people depend on manual methods like making announcements, pasting notices on boards, or spreading information through word of mouth. Some also use social media groups, but these platforms are not safe, organized, or reliable. Important posts are often lost in the flood of other unrelated content. Because of this, many valuable items remain unclaimed.

To solve this issue, I propose developing a **Lost and Found Web Application**. This system will act as a digital platform where individuals can **report lost items** and **post found items** in a structured way. Users will be able to upload details such as item description, location, date, and even photos, which will make it easier for the rightful owner to identify their belongings. With the help of this application, both the person who lost an item and the person who found it can connect quickly and securely.

The main goal of this project is to provide a user-friendly, secure, and efficient system that makes it easier for people to recover their lost items and reduces stress and time wastage.

1.2 Problem Statement

The traditional methods of handling lost and found items are inefficient and scattered. Notice boards, verbal communication, or social media groups do not guarantee that the information will reach the right person at the right time. Some of the major problems include:

- There is **no centralized platform** dedicated to lost and found reporting.
- **Time-consuming process**: It often takes days or weeks to locate the rightful owner.
- **Low trust and transparency** in current methods. For example, anyone can claim an item without proper verification.
- **Poor communication** between the finder and the owner.
- In many cases, **items remain unclaimed**, even when someone has actually found them.

Because of these issues, many students and community members are frustrated when they lose something important. A proper system is required to solve these problems in a systematic way.

1.3 Objectives

The main objectives of this project are:

- To develop a **digital platform** where individuals can report lost and found items.
- To allow users to upload detailed descriptions, dates, locations, and photos of items.
- To provide an easy **search and filter system** so that users can quickly find matching items.
- To improve the **chances of reuniting people with their lost belongings**.
- To build a safe and transparent platform where people can trust the process.
- To reduce the **time, stress, and uncertainty** that people face when they lose something valuable.

1.4 Scope and Limitation

Scope:

- The system will be a **web-based application** that works on any browser.
- Users will be able to **register, login, and manage their profiles**.
- Users can post **Lost Item Reports** and **Found Item Reports**.
- The application will allow users to **search and filter items** by category, date, or location.
- An **admin panel** will exist to review and manage reports, ensuring security and preventing misuse.
- Notification or alert feature will inform users when an item matching their report is added.

Limitations:

- The application will require a **stable internet connection**.
- It will be designed as a **web app only**, and a mobile application will not be included in this phase.
- The system will be most effective in a **closed community** (like a college or institution) rather than the general public.
- It will rely on users providing **accurate information** about items.

Chapter 2: Literature Review

Lost and Found systems are not new, but most of them are either offline or not user-friendly. Some institutions rely on physical notice boards, but this method is limited, as it requires students or staff to constantly check the board. Social media groups are sometimes used as an alternative, but they lack categorization, security, and reliability.

Several universities and organizations around the world have experimented with digital solutions, but they are often very limited in scope. They may not allow photos, or they lack an efficient search and filter system. In many cases, such systems are not maintained regularly, which leads to low user engagement.

By studying these existing systems, I realized that the main issues are **poor organization, lack of security, and low accessibility**. My proposed system addresses these weaknesses by providing a **centralized, secure, and well-structured platform** that focuses on the specific needs of a community, such as a college or workplace.

3.METHODOLOGY

This project will be done by using waterfall model with additional development and revision phase since most of the requirement of the project is already identified and well understood.

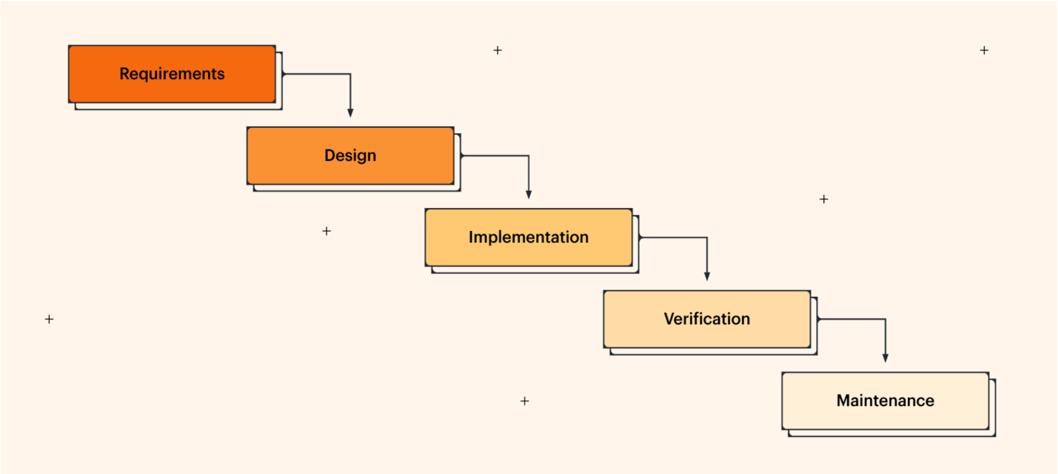

Figure 4. 1 Methodology of Lost and Found Web App

3.2 System Analysis

- **Functional Requirements:**
  - User registration, login, and profile management.
  - Ability to post Lost and Found reports with details and images.
  - Search and filter functionality for items.
  - Admin control to verify and manage posts.
  - Notification feature for matched items.
- **Non-functional Requirements:**
  - Security of user data and privacy.
  - Simple and user-friendly interface.
  - High availability and performance.

- Scalability for future improvements.

3.2.2 Feasibility Study

- **Technical Feasibility:**
  The system can be easily built with html css , javascript and php.

- **Economic Feasibility:**
  The cost of developing the system is minimal. Apart from hosting and internet charges, no major expenses are required.

- **Operational Feasibility:**
  The application will be simple to use, even for people with basic computer knowledge. No special training will be required.

Tools I Will Use:

- Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Backend:PHP(Any)
- Database: MySQL
- Hosting: Vercel / Heroku / GitHub Pages

3.3 System Design

The design will include:

- **Flowchart** of how items are reported and matched.
- **ER Diagram** to show relationships between users, items, and admin.
- **Use Case Diagram** showing user roles (User vs Admin).

High-Level Design Diagram

A high-level design diagram includes:

- Users (Admin) interacting with the system via web application
- Communication with the backend API through HTTPS.
- A Centralized database for storing all data.

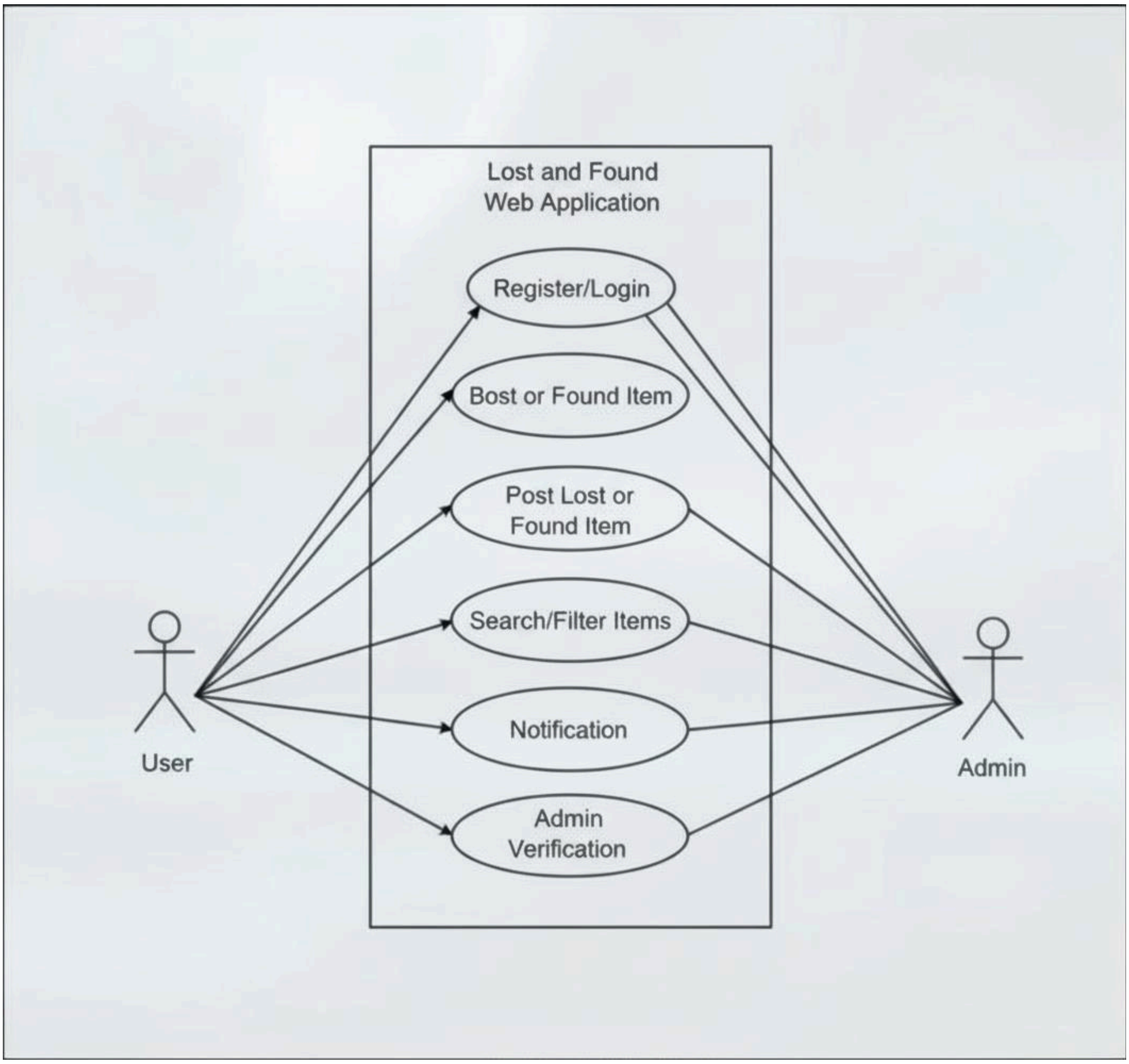

Figure 3.2.3:Use Case Diagram of Lost and Found Web

4.GANTT CHART

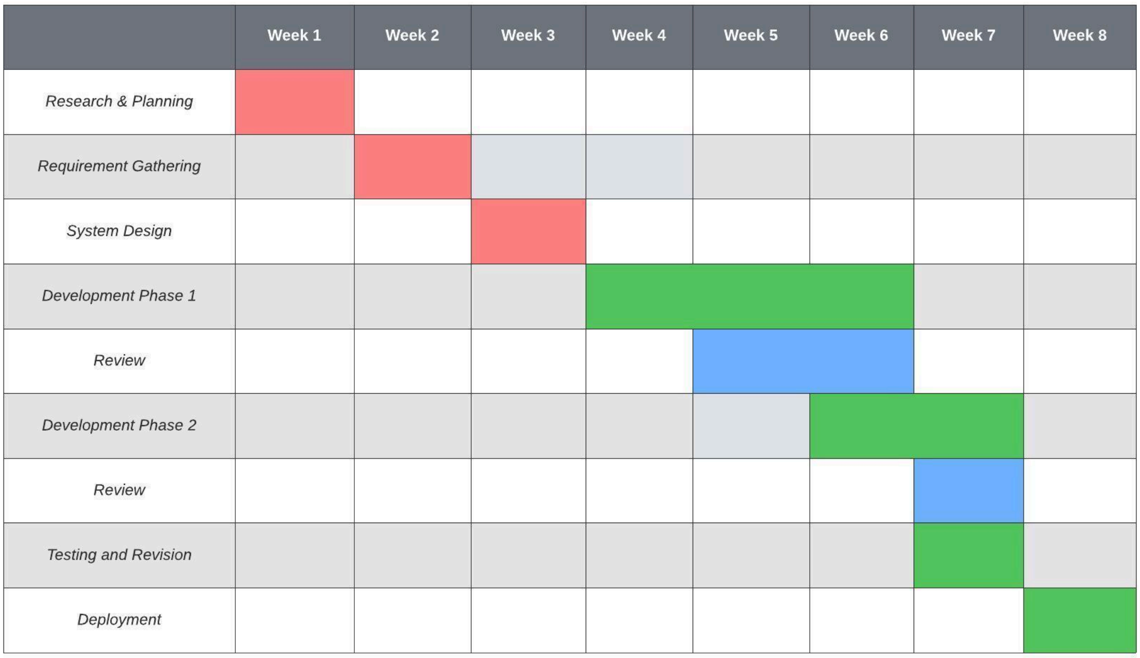

Figure 4. 1 Gantt chart of schedule timeline

1. **Project Initiation | 1 week:**

- Define project scope and objectives (Lost & Found system for students/users).
- Identify target users
- Conduct initial research on existing lost and found solutions.
- Collect basic requirements through surveys/interviews.

2. **Requirement Gathering & System Design | 2 weeks:**

- Design user interface mockups (home page, report lost item, report found item, admin dashboard).
- Define database structure (users, items, categories, status of items).
- Plan system architecture (frontend–backend–database interaction).

3. **Front-end Development | 3 weeks:**
    - Implement user interface using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript
    - Develop login, registration, and dashboard screens
    - Integrate location API

4. **Back-end Development | 3 weeks:**
    - Set up server infrastructure and database

- Implement user authentication and authorization
- Develop APIs for Adding lost/found items

5. **Database Implementation | 1 week:**
   - Design and create the database schema
   - Implement data storage and retrieval mechanisms
   - Ensure data integrity and security measures
6. **Analytics and Reporting | 2 weeks:**
   - Implement analytics for lost/found trends
   - Add category-wise and claim success rate analysis
   - Develop admin reporting tools
7. **Testing and Revision | 2 weeks:**
   - Conduct unit testing for individual components
   - Identify and fix bugs and issues
8. **Documentation review | 1 week:**
   - Prepare documentation and guides
9. **Project Review and Closure | 1 week:**
   - Evaluate project success and achievement of objectives
   - Gather feedback and make necessary improvements
   - Document lessons learned and finalize project closure

Chapter 5: Conclusion

The **Lost and Found Web Application** will act as a centralized platform for handling lost and found items in an efficient and reliable way. It will save time, reduce stress, and increase the chances of recovering lost belongings. Instead of relying on outdated notice boards or unorganized social media groups, users will have a structured and secure system to report and search for their items.

This project will not only benefit individual users but also improve the overall efficiency of the institution or community where it is implemented. It can later be expanded into a mobile application for broader accessibility.

5.1 Expected Output

- A fully functional web application where users can post lost and found items.
- A search and filter system to make item recovery faster.
- A secure admin-managed system to ensure trust and transparency.
- Increased recovery rate of lost items.
- A scalable platform with potential for future improvements.

References

1. **Kumar, S., Bhatnagar, D., Gahlot, D., Gola, B. S., & Rajput, G. (2022).** ***Web-Based Lost and Found System*****. MIT International Journal of Computer Science and Information Technology, 11(1), 7–14. Available at:** **https://www.researchgate.net/publication/376856933_Web-Based_Lost_and_Found_System**